

Argumentative Essay - SEIII

When one is asked about his or her dream major or future job, one might reply, “I don’t know,” or name some common jobs like teacher, doctor, or programmer, etc. However, many people may not realize that this is a decision that can influence their whole life. Nowadays, work or study occupies a large part of daily life for most individuals. Therefore, a major has become an extremely significant factor for many people. Thus, it is more important to choose a major that one is passionate about than one chosen mainly for good job prospects and higher earning potential, because a major often leads to a long-term career, passion supports sustained learning and skill growth, and purpose helps maintain well-being and performance.

First and foremost, a major will possibly represent one’s job. Usually, when one chooses a major, the next couple of years will be devoted to learning it. If one later changes to a job that is completely different from the original major, those years may lose some of their value. Hence, in most cases, individuals will choose the major they have learned and then insist on it as their future job. For this reason, it is important to think about the job itself, not only the major: if the daily work feels meaningful, long hours and repeated tasks become more manageable. For example, someone who studies nursing because of real interest in patient care may be more willing to improve clinical skills and communicate with patients than someone who chose it only for stability.

Second, passion matters because people often stay in a field for a long time, and long-term progress requires continuous learning. When one focuses on what he or she truly enjoys, one is more likely to practice, seek feedback, and keep improving, which forms a positive cycle in study and in work. This idea is supported by workplace research: according to Gallup, highly engaged business units experience 78% less absenteeism and 14% higher productivity, which suggests that sustained motivation is closely connected with stronger performance.

Third, passion and purpose also affect well-being, which influences whether someone can keep performing over many years. If a person studies or works in an area he or she strongly dislikes, boredom and stress can lead to poor concentration and burnout. In contrast, when a person has genuine interest, it is easier to stay focused and resilient. In a joint release from the World Health

Organization and the International Labor Organization, long working hours were linked to 745,000 deaths from stroke and ischemic heart disease in 2016, showing that unhealthy work patterns can have serious consequences. Moreover, research from Deloitte reports that 89% of Gen Z and 92% of millennials consider a sense of purpose important for job satisfaction and well-being, which supports the idea that meaning in work matters for mental health and persistence.

Even so, some may still argue that higher earnings can provide more options in life and make it more colorful. That may be true, but the premise is that one does the work well, and strong performance is difficult to maintain without motivation. In addition, according to Gallup's State of the Global Workplace, only 21% of employees worldwide were engaged in 2024, which suggests that many people struggle to stay motivated when work lacks personal connection. Therefore, relying only on salary can be risky, while genuine passion and purpose can support long-term effort and stability.

Overall, choosing a major that one is passionate about can provide a brighter future than choosing one mainly for good job prospects and higher earning potential. With passion for one's major and the related career, one is more likely to stay committed, build skills over time, and maintain well-being, rather than focusing only on pay or popularity. In this way, individuals can work toward a more meaningful and fruitful life.